



GPS-AI

AI Safe Practice Toolkit

Four tools to turn AI governance from a workshop topic into firm policy

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Companion resource to Strategic AI, Safe Practice: A Workshop for Accounting Leaders

Introduction

What This Toolkit Is

Four working documents from the Strategic AI, Safe Practice session, built for Australian accounting firms: a self-assessment checklist, a tool risk classification card, a 90-day governance roadmap, and an adoptable policy template. Not generic downloads — the exact tools referenced live in the session, ready to use.

Why It Matters

Most firms already use AI without a formal decision to do so — inside Xero, MYOB, or Microsoft 365 Copilot, not just in ChatGPT. TPB D62/2026 signals that regulators expect firms to know what they're using and govern it. A signed policy and evidence of review is what the TPB or your PI insurer will actually ask for, not good intentions.

TPB D62/2026 is still an exposure draft, not finalised guidance — check tpb.gov.au for current status. This toolkit is educational, not legal advice.

How to Use It

- 1. Self-Assessment Checklist** — start here — ten questions, ten minutes, tells you where your firm actually stands.
- 2. Risk Classification Card** — classify every tool you use as Public, Embedded, or Enterprise AI.
- 3. 90-Day Governance Roadmap** — turn what you found into a phased plan — Align, Prove, Scale.
- 4. Usage & Governance Policy Template** — adapt and sign — the document that turns awareness into evidence.

Key Benefits for Accountants

- **Clarity in ten minutes** — know your actual AI exposure without guesswork or a consultant.
- **Catches the blind spot** — surfaces the Embedded AI already running inside software you use daily.
- **Audit-ready evidence** — a signed policy and training register — what the TPB or your PI insurer expects to see.
- **Adapt, don't draft** — bracketed, editable template removes the blank-page problem.
- **Built for your size** — a firm of 2–20 staff can move from tool to signed policy in hours, not months.

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GPS-AI AI OBLIGATIONS SELF-ASSESSMENT CHECKLIST

Ten questions. Five minutes. Your firm's AI risk posture, right now.

For each question, mark Yes or No. Be honest rather than aspirational — this is a working diagnostic, not a compliance certificate.

#	Question	Obligation	Y / N
1	Does your firm have a written AI policy?	APES 110 — competence	
2	Does your engagement letter address AI tool use?	TPB Code — confidentiality	
3	Can you name the AI features active in your practice software (e.g. Xero, MYOB, Microsoft 365) without checking?	APES 110 — competence	
4	Have you reviewed your AI vendors' data processing terms in the last 12 months?	APES 110 — confidentiality	
5	Is there a documented review step before AI outputs reach a client?	TPB Code — competence	
6	Do clients consent to AI processing their data?	Privacy Act 1988; TPB Code	
7	Does your team understand the difference between Public, Embedded and Enterprise AI?	APES 110 — competence	
8	Does your PI insurer know you use AI in client work?	APES 110 — professional behaviour	
9	Do you have a response protocol for when an AI output turns out to be wrong?	TPB Code — reasonable care	
10	Has your team read the APESB Technical Alert on AI (31 October 2025)?	APESB Technical Alert, Oct 2025	

Score yourself**8–10 YES**

Compliant posture

5–7 YES

Review required — prioritise your No answers

Under 5 YES

Immediate action needed — contact GPS-AI

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Scored under 5? Book a Rapid AI Governance Review — a 90-minute, firm-level session where we map your exposure, build your policy, and brief your team.

GPS-AI Disclaimer

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Where this material references draft, proposed, or pending regulation, standards, or guidance, confirm current status with the relevant regulator before treating it as settled. GPS-AI accepts no liability for outcomes arising from use of this material without appropriate professional review.

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AI TOOL RISK CLASSIFICATION CARD

Three categories. Three risk levels. One framework.

Every AI tool your firm uses — knowingly or not — falls into one of these three categories. Classify it, then apply the minimum action.

PUBLIC AI HIGHEST RISK <i>ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini · Perplexity</i> Client data should not enter these tools without documented consent and controls — inputs may be used to improve the provider's own models.	EMBEDDED AI MODERATE–HIGH RISK <i>Xero AI · MYOB AI · Microsoft 365 Copilot · practice-management AI features</i> The category most firms aren't managing — it doesn't feel like a choice, because it's already running inside software you use every day.	ENTERPRISE AI LOWER RISK, IF GOVERNED <i>Private / closed-loop deployments — no external data sharing</i> Lower risk because data isn't shared externally. But lower risk is not no risk — governance is still required.
MINIMUM ACTION Do not enter identifiable client data. Anonymise all inputs. AI policy required before use.	MINIMUM ACTION Audit which AI features are active. Review all AI-assisted output before use. Disclose in your engagement letter.	MINIMUM ACTION Written AI policy required. Staff training mandatory. Annual review under APES 110.

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Not sure how to classify a tool already running in your firm? Book a Rapid AI Governance Review — GPS-AI maps your exposure and builds the policy with you.

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GPS-AI AI POLICY TEMPLATE

Eight required elements. One page. Ready to adopt and sign.

FIRM NAME	POLICY OWNER	EFFECTIVE DATE	NEXT REVIEW

1. PURPOSE — Governs how [Firm Name] and its staff use AI tools in client work, to protect client confidentiality and meet our obligations under APES 110, the TPB Code, the Privacy Act 1988 and (where applicable) APRA CPS 230.

2. TOOL CLASSIFICATION — Every AI tool is classified as Public, Embedded or Enterprise AI (see the AI Tool Risk Classification Card) and logged in the firm's AI Tool Inventory before use in client work.

3. CLIENT DATA PROHIBITION — Identifiable client data must not be entered into Public AI tools without documented client consent and an approved anonymisation process. Embedded and Enterprise AI require a documented vendor data review.

4. REVIEW REQUIREMENTS — All AI-generated output is treated as an unverified first draft. A qualified staff member must review and approve it before it reaches a client, is filed, or is relied upon.

5. CONSENT PROCESS — Where AI processes client data — including meeting transcription or embedded practice-software features — client consent is recorded via the engagement letter or a specific written disclosure before use.

6. STAFF TRAINING — All staff using AI in client work complete AI literacy induction before first use, and refresher training annually, covering this policy, the risk classification framework, and review requirements.

7. INCIDENT RESPONSE — Any suspected AI-related breach is reported to [Policy Owner] within 24 hours. [Policy Owner] assesses the obligations affected, notifies the client and/or PI insurer if required, and documents the remediation.

8. ANNUAL REVIEW — This policy is reviewed annually, and immediately after any significant regulatory change or material AI-related incident. Review date and next review date are recorded above.

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Approved by: _____ Date: _____

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Need help implementing this? GPS-AI runs a Rapid AI Governance Review — 90 minutes, we map your exposure, build your policy, and brief your team.

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GPS-AI 90-DAY AI GOVERNANCE ROADMAP

Three phases. Three outputs. A governed AI practice.

Your first 90 days, from tool inventory to a trained, policy-backed team. One phase at a time — no shortcuts, no shopping lists.

1

ALIGN — Days 1–30: Audit & Assess

List every software tool. Check each for AI features — including what you didn't know was AI. Ask every staff member what they use personally. Apply the three-tier risk classification.

OUTPUT Tool Inventory + Risk Gap List

Know what's actually running in your firm, and name your single highest-risk touchpoint.

2

PROVE — Days 31–60: Policy & Pilot

Complete the 10-question self-assessment as a firm. Draft your one-page AI policy covering all eight required elements. Test it on one governed pilot, with a documented review step before anything reaches a client.

OUTPUT Signed AI Policy + One Governed Pilot

A signed, one-page policy. For a firm of 2–20 staff, drafting takes 2–3 hours.

3

SCALE — Days 61–90: Train & Embed

Deliver a 30-minute team briefing using the AI Tool Risk Classification Card. Walk through the three breach scenarios from the session. Collect signed acknowledgements and embed the policy in your SOPs.

OUTPUT Team Trained + Signed Acknowledgements

Evidence of compliance — this is what the TPB or your PI insurer asks for when something goes wrong.

*Pair this roadmap with the **AI Tool Risk Classification Card** and the **One-Page AI Policy** template.*

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